

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 5-00-086

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
EL DORADO IRRIGATION DISTRICT
EL DORADO LIFT STATION EQUALIZATION POND
EL DORADO COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

- A.** The El Dorado Irrigation District (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge (RWD) dated 8 July 1998 and a "Design Study for El Dorado Irrigation District, El Dorado Lift Station South Street, El Dorado, El Dorado County, California" dated July 1998 for the equalization pond (North Pond) at the El Dorado Lift Station. These Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) apply to the collection system discharging to the lift station, the lift station, and the equalization pond.
- B.** The facility is in Section 35, T10N, R10E, MDB&M, as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference. The equalization pond is approximately 1.5 miles south of Highway 50, in the town of El Dorado. It is at the end of South Street, about ¼ mile west of the South Street/Church Street intersection.
- C.** According to the Discharger, the Assessor's Parcel Numbers as 331: 25: 252: 01 and 02. Latitude and Longitude are 38° 40' 54" N and 120° 50' 44" W respectively.
- D.** WDRs are being issued based upon the information submitted with the 8 July 1998 RWD.
- E.** The facility formerly served as El Dorado Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP), known as Sanitation District No. II. In the late 1970's the WWTP was replaced by the El Dorado Lift Station and the Mother Lode Force Main.
- F.** Since the lift station was constructed, the facultative ponds were increasingly used for flow peak shaving or flow equalization to temporarily store excess flow due to increased Inflow and Infiltration (I/I). The Discharger has now decided to use only the North Pond for flow equalization. The North Pond occupies a surface area of approximately 1.8 acres. It has a capacity of approximately 3 million gallons and ranges in depth from 7 to 8 feet.
- G.** In 1997 the lift station was expanded. However, even with the increased pumping capacity, the North Pond is still needed for temporary emergency storage due to I/I. With five to six inches of rain in only a few days, 1.5 million gallons of overflow from the lift station can easily accumulate in the equalization pond.
- H.** The Mother Lode Force Main is approximately nine miles long and terminates at the Deer Creek WWTP. In order to allow smaller connections to pump into the force main, the El

Dorado Lift Station has large pumps (1,900 gallons per minute (gpm)) that operate for 20 minutes and small pumps (1,000 gpm) that operate for the remaining 40 minutes of each hour. The down stream connections are able to pump into the system during the 40 minutes that the small pumps are on. Pumping time for the large and small pumps may vary depending on demand.

- I.** Discharges to the El Dorado Lift Station are primarily domestic, with few commercial hookups. Estimated effluent Biochemical Oxygen Demand is 80 mg/l (winter) and 200 mg/l (summer).
- J.** The North Pond's native material has been reworked and compacted to a 95% relative compaction achieving 1.0×10^{-6} cm/sec permeability liner.
- K.** A natural spring is reported to flow at a rate of 10 gpm (summer) to 25 gpm (winter) into the North Pond. However, the spring has now been diverted to the natural drainage near the southeast end of the site with a slurry cut off wall.
- L.** Geologic conditions at the site are reported to be predominantly a reddish brown, moist, very soft to soft, clay and silty-clayey sand to a depth of approximately seven feet. Below this depth, a weathered bedrock was encountered that consists of reddish brown Argillite, closely fractured, moderately weathered, strong to very strong metasedimentary bedrock. Groundwater exists at approximately four feet below grade.
- M.** The North Pond is intended to be used as an equalization basin only, and only during the winter season to accommodate overflow from the lift station due to large storm events.
- N.** Improvements to the El Dorado Lift Station included:

 - 1. Diversion of the natural spring upstream of the North Pond by the construction of a slurry cut off wall with diversion to south end of the site.
 - 2. Regrading the North Pond slopes to an approximate 2:1 (H:V), and the pond bottom.
 - 3. Scarifying, moisture condition and recompacting the pond sediment to 95% of its maximum dry density at moisture content of 2 to 4% over optimum.
 - 4. Establishment of a vegetative visual screen along the northern limit of the North Pond.
- O.** The Board has considered antidegradation pursuant to State Board Resolution No. 68-16 and finds that the discharge is consistent with those provisions, and will not cause an increase in groundwater constituents above that of background levels.
- P.** The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Fourth Edition, for the Sacramento River and the San Joaquin River Basins (hereafter Basin Plan), which designates beneficial uses and

water quality objectives for waters of the Basins. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.

- Q.** The beneficial uses of the underlying ground water are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
- R.** The Basin Plan encourages reclamation.
- S.** Surface water drainage is to an unnamed tributary of Slate Creek, which is in turn tributary to Weber Creek tributary to the South Fork of the American River. The site is located in the Weber Creek Hydrologic Sub Area near Shingle Springs.
- T.** The existing beneficial uses of the American River are municipal and industrial supply; recreation; esthetic enjoyment; ground water recharge; stock watering, power, contact recreation, canoeing and rafting, non-contact recreation, potential warm and cold freshwater habitat; cold water spawning, and wildlife habitat.
- U.** The beneficial uses of the underlying groundwater are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply.
- V.** This is a minor alteration to an existing facility, which was constructed prior to November 1970, where the reconstruction of the existing wastewater treatment pond does not constitute an expansion; therefore this project is exempt from California Environmental Quality Act under the categorical exemption 15302 Replacement or Reconstruction, Section (c).
- W.** This discharge is exempt from the requirements of *Consolidated Regulations for Treatment, Storage, Processing, or Disposal of Solid Waste*, as set forth in Title 27, CCR, Division 2, Subdivision 1, Section 20005, et seq., (hereinafter Title 27). The exemption, pursuant to Section 20090(b), is based on the following:
1. The Board is issuing waste discharge requirements, and
 2. The discharge complies with the Basin Plan, and
 3. The waste material does not need to be managed according to Chapter 11, Division 4.5, Title 22, of the CCR as a designated or hazardous waste.
- X.** The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and a 30-day opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
- Y.** The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that El Dorado Irrigation District, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted hereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. By-pass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous,' as defined in Sections 2520 & 2521(a) of Chapter 15, or 'designated,' as defined in Section 13173 of the California Water Code, is prohibited.
4. Any wastewater disposal or long term storage within 900-feet of any domestic well, or 100-feet of any irrigation well or watercourse is prohibited.
5. The temporary storage of wastewater in any pond other than the North Pond is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a pollution or nuisance as defined by the Porter-Cologne Water Quality Control Act, Section 13050.
2. Only domestic and commercial wastewater overflow from the El Dorado Lift Station owned by the Discharger shall be accepted for temporary storage at the El Dorado Lift Station Equalization Pond.
3. Public contact with wastewater water shall be precluded through such means as fences with placards notifying the public that sewage is being treated within.
4. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and storage area.
5. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. 4, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of the wastewater ponds and storage ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l
6. The discharge to the ponds or disposal area shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
7. The discharge shall not cause degradation of any water supply.

8. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. In particular,
 - a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on any water surface.
9. North Pond shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate the overflow wastewater from the El Dorado Lift Station and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration during a winter season. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on either a flood or storm total precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed daily in accordance with maximum daily historical rainfall pattern.
10. Plant design shall be constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to floods, storms, or winter season with a 100-year return frequency. Pond freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).
11. Before **1 October** of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specifications No. 9 and 10.

C. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludge, grease and oil, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with CCR, Title 27 and approved by the Executive Officer.
2. Use and disposal of sludge shall comply with existing Federal and State laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR part 503.

If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards are given the authority to implement regulations contained in the 40 CFR part 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The Discharger must comply with the standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR part 503 whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

3. The Discharger is encouraged to comply with the State Guidance Manual issued by the Department of Health Services titled *Manual of Good Practice for Landspreading of Sewage Sludge*.

4. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice from a previously approved practice should be reported to the Executive Officer and US Environmental Protection Agency Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.

D. Groundwater Limitations:

1. The discharge, in combination with other sources, shall not cause underlying groundwater to contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality, except for coliform. For coliform, increases shall not cause the most probable number of total coliform organisms to exceed 2.2/100 ml over any 7-day period.

E. Provisions:

1. By **1 June 2000** the Discharger shall submit a sludge disposal plan.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) No. 5-00-086, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
3. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
4. The Discharger shall report promptly any material change or proposed change in the discharge character, location, or volume and/or the treatment train and/or the wastewater treatment facility components.
5. The Discharger shall comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
6. At least 90 days prior to termination or expiration of any lease, contract, or agreement involving treatment area, used to justify the capacity authorized herein and assure compliance with this Order, the Discharger shall notify the Board in writing of the situation and of what measures have been taken or are being taken to assure full compliance with this Order.

7. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.
8. The Discharger shall immediately notify the Board by telephone whenever a violation or an adverse condition occurs as a result of the wastewater treatment operations; a written confirmation providing a complete description of the event shall follow within one week.
9. Operating personnel shall keep a copy of this Order at the El Dorado Lift Station Equalization Pond site for reference. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
10. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 28 April 2000.

GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

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